



Google Now gets Smarter

Reports suggest Google Now gets more smarter and ability to understand complex questions <http://dgit.in/GglNowSmarter>



Tears of joy!

Oxford dictionary named its word of the year 2015 and it happens to be emoji <http://dgit.in/tearofjoy>

Industry Connect

phone our app looks at the consumption of data of the sponsored application, measures the consumption of data and then basically says that you have used, as an example, 22 MB of Saavn in 24 hours of which 20 MB were free and we basically say that you have earned a 20 MB data refund. We keep track of all the earned data and when the earned data refund gets to 150, we give you a data pack of 150 MB.

4 Even Internet.org with all its goals in the right place did come under the scanner for violating net neutrality. So, does your concept violate net neutrality in any way? And if not, how?

Sailesh: Yes, we all believe that it is important to bring lots of people online who can't afford it. There are many approaches of doing it and yes some of those approaches do violate the spirit of network neutrality. Network neutrality is important because it has helped the internet to get where we are today, and it is going to continue to keep the internet free. Our approach is in fact pro net neutrality for a couple of reasons: First of all, you have to use your data and then you get a rebate. The data pack that you get back from Gigato, has no strings attached to it. It is 150 MB of data that you can use on any application! You need not use it only on the applica-

little questionable because it would mean that only established players with deep pockets can potentially come on board if they are intending to subsidize their users internet charges.

Sailesh: Look, that is an issue, but not a net neutrality issue. It has never been illegal to give cashbacks. It has never been illegal to aggressively discount your product. It does not violate network neutrality. Net neutrality talks about a different set of principles.

4 It talks about creating preferred high-ways for certain set of people. But in a way, at least in spirit, this seems to be the same thing. I'm not talking about breaking any laws.

Sailesh: Neither am I. I'm talking about the spirit of net neutrality as well. The question is, does someone giving you a cashback make it harder for smaller parties to participate in a business? If there is a shopkeeper, who says come to my store and buy rice and I will pay the bus charges that you incurred in coming to my shop, does that create unfair advantage? Well, if you say it does, that's what a free market is all about. Net neutrality is about a different set of things. There are no laws yet, the laws are being formulated, but the principles around which we all discuss, are principles of net neutrality and often in this discus-

it requires working closely with an operator and the only operator that it works with in India is Reliance. But what we do works on all operators in all circles which is important for us because when we go and work with say a Jabong or TrulyMadly or Faasos, in some sense they don't really care who your operator is. They want your business and they want to reward your loyalty. They going and buying a data pack for say the Mumbai circle from Vodafone for you, and an Idea data pack for someone else.... that's too much complexity for them.

4 So within your set of partners, do you try to safeguard existing partners from a "conflict of interest" type of situation? For eg. If Jabong is on board, would you get Myntra on board?

Sailesh: Not true. Everybody gets to come on board and we tell all our partner that there is no exclusivity. It is absolutely in my interest to have more people, more apps on this platform because then there is higher likelihood that more the apps that you use on a regular basis are sponsoring data. And that is important to me, because conceptually I want to bring down your cost of the internet. This is about putting more megabytes in pockets of consumers.

4 Lofty ideals, serving greater good – I'm on board with all of that. Though the question arises – what's Gigato's business model?

Sailesh: We charge for every megabyte that we give out to users. The app developers have to pay for that and we take a small commission on top. For every user that's on our platform there's also a fee. But basically the model is: there is a cost per megabyte (which we purchase) plus we charge a small commission to the app developer.

In effect we are buying data packs from the operators and it is exactly the same price that you would pay for a data pack so we don't even get any preference from them. **4**

This was just an excerpt, to read the full interview with Shailesh Nalawadi, Blipp this page.

“What Gigato does is that it provides a platform which allows mobile app developers to pay for the data that their users consume.”

tion that gave you that data. Second is, any service provider can decide “Hey I also want to get in this action and I also want to reward my users by giving free internet.” So we are not precluding anyone, and the third thing is everybody on our platform pays the same per megabyte charges. There is no backroom deals that says that jabong pays less but flipkart pays more!

4 With the point one and three, I can fully agree with, but point two, I find it a

sion on “Save the Internet”, the issue of small player vs the big player comes into play. It kind of creates more confusion on the entire discussion on net neutrality that's the distinction I wanted to make.

4 I get it. Nice analogy by the way.

Sailesh: Yes! So Internet.org focuses on some of the problems, which is that they kind of handpick who is in the internet.org ecosystem and who is not. They are now trying to change that. Second,